Scientific management

The use of the scientific method to determine the “ one best way” for a job to be done.

Who is called the father of scientific management?

Frederick Winslow Taylor (1856-1915) was the father of scientific management. He worked at Midvale steel company. Taylor witnessed many inefficiencies . He sought to create a mental revolution among both workers and managers by defining clear guidelines for improving production efficiency.

What are the Taylor's four principles of scientific management?

1. Develop a science for each element of an individual's work, which will replace the old rule thump method.
2. Scientifically select and then train, teach, and develop the worker.
3. Heartily cooperate with the workers so as to ensure that all work is done in accordance with the principles of the science that has been developed.
4. Divide work and responsibility almost equally between management and workers. Management takes over all work for which it is better fitted than the workers.

What is general administrative theorists?

Writers who developed general theories of what managers do and what constitutes good management practice.

- Henri Fayol
- Max Weber

Who is called father of modern management?

Henri Fayol is known as the father of modern management. Fayol described management as a universal set of functions that included planning, organizing, leading and controlling that can be applied in all types of organization and in home.

Fayol wrote during the same period as Taylor. While Taylor was concerned with first line managers and the scientific method, Fayol's attention was directed at the activities of all managers.

Fayal's fourteen principles of management

1. Division of work
2. Authority and responsibility
3. Discipline
4. Unity of command
5. Unity of direction
6. Subordination of individual interest to general interest
7. Remuneration
8. Centralization
9. Scalar chain
10. Order
11. Equity
12. Stability of tenure of personnel
13. Initiative
14. Esprit de corps.

Fayal's fourteen principles of management(continue…)

1. Division of work: Division of work means deduction of the number of objectives towards which attention and effort are to be directed. The work should be divided on the basis of homogeneity so that specialization can be achieved.

2. Authority and responsibility: Authority is the legitimate power. Power is the ability to influence others. Managers must be able to give orders and authority gives them this right. Authority is the command over resources (human or non human). Authority must be equal to task . Responsibility is the corollary to authority. Corollary means if you apply authority, you will be made responsible.

3. Discipline: Every organization has got its own rules and regulations. All employees should have respect and must abide by these rules and regulations. From sweeper to owner (Henri Fayol)

Fayal's fourteen principles of management(continue…)

4. Unity of command: Every employee should receive orders from only one superior.

5. Unity of Direction: The organization should have a single plan of action to guide managers and workers. It is to be noted that departmental objectives must be in line with the main objectives of the organization. In other words, sub objectives of an organization must follow the main objective of the organization.

6. Subordination of individual interest to general interest: The interests of any one employee or group of employees should not take precedence over the interest of the organization as a whole.

7. Remuneration: Workers must be paid a fair, reasonable salary and reward to effort by the organization.

Fayal's fourteen principles of management(continue…)

8. Centralization : Centralization is an organizational arrangement which decreases the importance of subordinates.

9. Scalar chain: Scalar chain is the line of authority that shows authority and responsibility relationship. In other words it shows who will give direction and who will follow that direction.

10. Order: People and materials should in the right place at the right time. Right man for the right job.

11. Equity: Fair and equitable behavior to all. It is the combination of kindness and justice.

Fayal's fourteen principles of management(continue…)

12. Stability of tenure of personnel : Make job permanent after observation of employee performance.

13. Initiative: Employees who are allowed to originate and carry out plans will exert high levels of effort.

14. Esprit de corps : Unity is strength. Management is a group effort. So a manager must try to create team sprit among his members.

What is Max Weber's ideal bureaucracy?

Max Weber was a German sociologist who studied organizational activity. Weber described an ideal type of organization which he called a bureaucracy-

A form organization characterized by division of labor, a clearly defined hierarchy, detailed rules and regulations and impersonal relationship.

Characteristics of Bureaucratic organization:

1. Hierarchy of authority: Authority flows from top to bottom.
2. Division of work: Jobs broken down into simple, routine, and well defined tasks.
3. Career orientation: Managers are career professionals, not owners of units they have.
4. Formal rules and regulations: System of written rules and standard operating procedures.
5. Formal selection: People selected for jobs based on technical qualification

What is Max Weber's ideal bureaucracy?

6. Role structure: Functional definition or boundary of workers in a position. It requires developing job description which tells basic responsibility, duties of employees.

7. Impersonality: In bureaucracy, the focus is given to someone's position. There is no human consideration. Human is not important in it. Power is to be given in person's position not the person. For example, we never address a ' manager' Abdul karim, we simply say ' manager'. It is perpetual entity of an organization.